

TIMELINE 1864

The Wilderness Campaign ■ **Battle of Cold Harbor** ■ The Valley Campaign ■ **Siege of Petersburg** ■ Battle of the Crater ■ **Sinking of the CSS *Alabama*** ■ Battle of Mobile Bay ■ **The Atlanta Campaign** ■ Franklin and Nashville ■ **March to the Sea**

“Not expecting to see you again before the Spring campaign opens, **I wish to express ... my entire satisfaction** with what you have done up to this time.”

LINCOLN'S FINAL DIRECTIVE TO GRANT ON THE EVE OF THE 1864 CAMPAIGN

JANUARY	FEBRUARY	MARCH	APRIL	MAY	JUNE	JULY	AUGUST	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER
JANUARY Though little large-scale fighting takes place, there is much skirmishing from Virginia to Tennessee and Mississippi. JANUARY 20 Confederate armies that Union naval vessels sight by its capture Mobile Bay in Alabama are justified when Admiral David Farragut makes a reconnaissance in force. JANUARY 20-31 The Union bombardment of Charleston, South Carolina, begins five months earlier, months with 353 rounds being fired in three days.	FEBRUARY 14-20 A rising cohort from Vicksburg, led by General William T. Sherman, arrives at Memphis, Mississippi. For five days it destroys Confederate railroads, depots, arsenals, and hospitals. FEBRUARY 17 For the first time in history a submarine, the CSS <i>Hurley</i>, sinks a warship, the USS <i>Albatross</i>, outside Charleston Harbor. FEBRUARY 20 The Battle of Chancellorsville, the major engagement of the war in Florida, results in a Union defeat. FEBRUARY 27 The first Union prisoners arrive at Andersonville, or Camp Sumter, in Georgia.	MARCH 1-2 General Jason Kilpatrick leads a Union cavalry raid on Richmond, Virginia, forcing to the city's outskirts his forces were turned aside and scattered by local militia men. MARCH 9 General Ulysses S. Grant is appointed commander-in-chief of all Union armies. MARCH 10 General Nathaniel Banks initiates a two-month, joint army-navy expedition up Louisiana's Red River to force Confederate forces in the Trans-Mississippi western United States. MARCH 16 Confederate General Nathan Bedford Forrest mounts a month-long raid into Union-held Tennessee and Kentucky.	APRIL 8-9 Confederates at Manassas and Potomac rail decisively halt Sherman's advance up the Red River toward Shreveport, Louisiana. APRIL 12 Confederate forces commanded by Forrest capture Fort Pillow on the Mississippi River, massacring many of the Black soldiers in the garrison. APRIL 20 Confederate forces and the ironclad USS <i>Alabama</i> recapture the port of Plymouth, North Carolina.	MAY Grant's coordinated offensives against the various Confederate armies get underway. MAY 5-6 In Virginia, Grant and Lee first clash in the fateful Battle of the Wilderness. MAY 7 In Georgia, Sherman confronts General Joseph E. Johnston's Army of Tennessee. MAY 8-21 In Virginia, the "Bloody Angle" struggle on May 12 marks the fiercest fighting in the Battle of Spotsylvania. MAY 11 A major Union cavalry raid on Richmond, led by General Philip Sheridan, encourages General Jeb Stuart's Confederate horsemen at Yellow Tavern, only a mile (1.6 km) north of the city. Stuart is mortally wounded. MAY 16 At the Battle of Drewry's Bluff south of Richmond, General P. G. T. Beauregard compels Union General Benjamin Butler to retreat to the Bermuda Hundred peninsula. MAY 19 Off the coast of France, USS <i>Kearsarge</i> sinks the commerce raider CSS <i>Alabama</i>. MAY 27 In Georgia, Johnston checks Sherman at Kennesaw Mountain.	JUNE 3 At Cold Harbor, Lee repulses Grant with heavy losses. JUNE 8 In Baltimore, Lincoln is nominated for a second term by the National Union Party. JUNE 10 In Mississippi, Forrest wins a brilliant victory over superior numbers at Brice's Crossroads. JUNE 18 After unsuccessful Union attempts to capture the rail junction of Petersburg, Virginia, Grant and Lee settle down to a nine-month siege. JUNE 19 Off the coast of France, USS <i>Kearsarge</i> sinks the commerce raider CSS <i>Alabama</i>. JUNE 27 In Georgia, Johnston checks Sherman at Kennesaw Mountain.	JULY 11 Confederate General Jubal Early leads his small Army of the Valley to the outskirts of Washington, D.C., causing consternation in the capital. JULY 20-29 Replacing Johnston as commander of the Army of Tennessee, General John Bell Hood launches a series of bloody battles—Peachtree Creek, Chatahoo, and Ezra Church—that all to destroy Sherman's forces. JULY 30 Union forces explode an enormous mine beneath Confederate lines at Petersburg, but their subsequent attacks are decisively defeated at the Battle of the Crater. AUGUST 1 At Mobile Bay, Farragut finally leads a fleet of 18 Union warships past forts and through minefields to win the Battle of Mobile Bay. AUGUST 18-19 Union forces capture the Weldon Railroad heading south from besieged Petersburg, Virginia. AUGUST 21 General George McClellan is nominated for president by the peace-leaning Democratic Party.	SEPTEMBER 1 Having been defeated at Jonesboro, Hood evacuates Atlanta and Union troops soon capture the city. SEPTEMBER 17 Farragut drops out of the presidential race, leaving the contest to Lincoln and McClellan. SEPTEMBER 19 General Philip Sheridan's Army of the Shenandoah smashes Jubal Early's Confederates at the Third Battle of Winchester. SEPTEMBER 29-30 Grant launches coordinated attacks at each end of the Richmond-Petersburg line: at Fort Harrison to the north and at Red Bank Farm to the southwest.	OCTOBER Sheridan burns barns and mills in Virginia's Shenandoah Valley, destroying the transportation of the Confederacy. OCTOBER 19 After Confederates launch a surprise attack, Sheridan repels his demoralized troops and decisively wins the Battle of Cedar Creek. OCTOBER 22 General Sheridan's Third Cavalry, near Kansas City, defeats a massive Confederate force into Missouri, it deflates at Kansas City. OCTOBER 27 Hood attempts to cut the Boydton Plank Road, a vital supply route for Lee's beleaguered army at Petersburg, are frustrated by Confederate troops.	NOVEMBER William T. Sherman NOVEMBER 6 Abraham Lincoln is re-elected president of the United States. NOVEMBER 16 After burning much of Atlanta, Sherman initiates on his "March to the Sea," cutting a swath of destruction through Georgia. NOVEMBER 30 Hood embarking on an ambitious scheme to drive north through Tennessee to the Ohio River, attacks strong Union positions at Franklin and loses nearly a third of his army.	DECEMBER 15-16 In a series of assaults on Hood's positions before Nashville, General George Thomas' Union forces overwhelm and nearly destroy the Confederate Army of Tennessee. DECEMBER 21 Sheridan "Marches to the Sea" reaches its end with the capture of Savannah, Georgia. DECEMBER 24-25 Nearly 60 Federal warships bombard Fort Fisher outside Wilmington, North Carolina, but General Butler's exposed force is repulsed by Confederates. The forts will lead to Butler's being removed from command.	